

expect/actual is the wrong default

Every KMP tutorial teaches it first. Then people use it for everything, and the shared code turns into a knot.

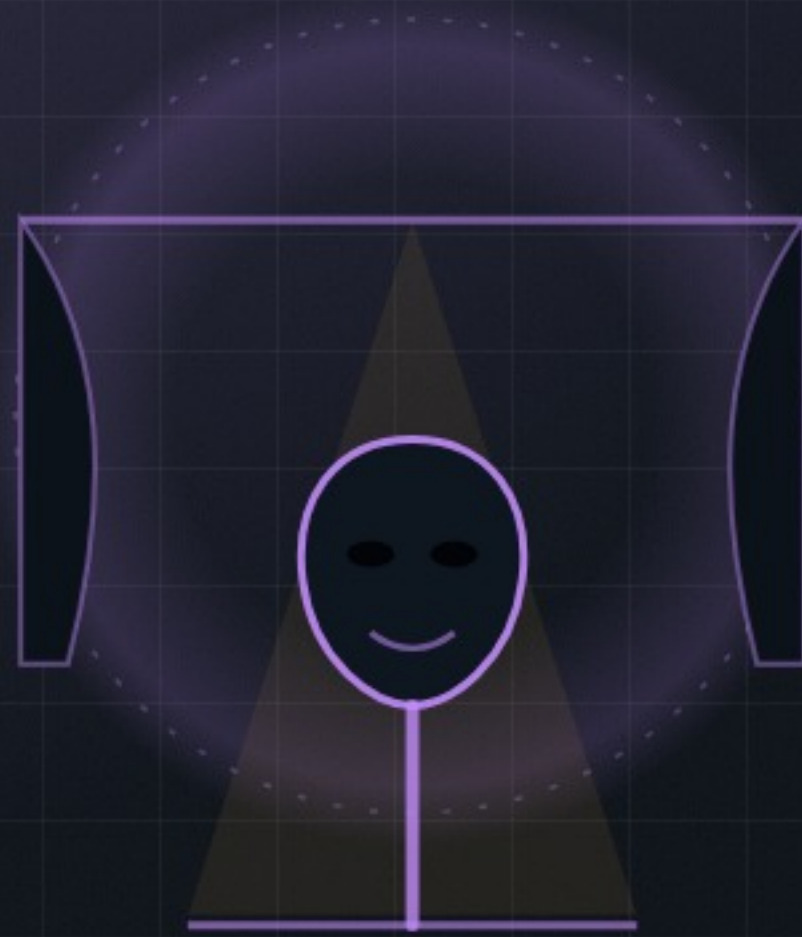


```
actual fun clipboard()  
    cast at compile time
```



// THE CAST

Cast by name. No swapping.



```
actual fun clipboard()  
    cast at compile time
```

THE UNDERSTUDY

exhibit 06

actual

A stand-in cast at compile time, on stage every night. Perfect for a small fixed role. Useless when the part needs to change, because you cannot swap an understudy mid-run.



The Loopdown

@darkpandawarrior

02 / 05

swipe

// THE ALTERNATIVE

An interface in common, injected per platform

```
// androidMain
actual class Clipboard actual constructor() {
    actual fun copy(text: String) { /* android impl */ }
}
```



Weld, or hinge?

01 Varies, or needs a fake
interface in common, inject the platform impl

02 Small, fixed, one per platform
expect/actual is fine, and simplest

03 Ask: can I test this?
you cannot inject a fake into a weld

04 Ask: will there be two?
an understudy plays exactly one role

Reach for the tool that keeps your options open

Interfaces and injection compose, and they test.
expect/actual welds.

Use the weld only where you genuinely want one
permanent joint.